You create an online web application and you want to define its access policy for the resources which you wish to protect? Or maybe you want to verify the identity of users visiting your website? In this tutorial, I will show you how simple it is to authenticate and authorizate your application using the popular rails gems: **Devise**, **CanCanCan**, and **Rolify**.

What is authentication and authorization?

Authentication is a confirmation of user identity, while authorization determines whether you can access a particular resource.

What is Devise?

Devise is a flexible authentication solution for Rails. It is composed of 10 modules. For example, one module called Trackable, tracks sign in counts, timestamps, and locates IP addresses. Creating a user authentication system is piece of cake when using Devise.

What is Rolify and CanCanCan?

Rolify is Roles library which supporting scope on resource object without any authorization enforcement.